

BenQ CRW4816A

Write on

The BenQ 4816A is a CD-ReWritable drive with a 48X read and write speed and a 16X rewrite speed.

This corresponds to a rated speed of 7200 KBps while reading and writing on CD-ROMs, and a speed of

cent less than the best drives with the same speed specifications. The CD registration speed of 12 seconds is a long time, that needs to be improved upon. It took 259 seconds to burn a 650 MB Audio CD, which means an



2400 KBps on rewritable media. Since the drive uses BenQ's trademark Seamless Link technology there is no buffer under-run, which could severely affect the performance of the drive.

The CD tray is quite sturdy and comes out smoothly when the eject button is pressed. There is also a volume control, play and skip button, and a headphone jack on the front panel. It also has an analogue, as well as a digital output connector at the back. The emergency eject hole allows you to unload the disk manually in the absence of power.

The drive supports different writing modes such as Disc-at-once, Track-at-once, Multi-session, Packet writing and Raw writing. The CRW4816A was tested on a Pentium 4 2.8 GHz system with, Samsung 512 MB of RD RAM and an IBM Deskstar 40 GB hard disk drive. The drive performed reasonably while reading and writing assorted data.

The ISO and assorted write speeds are about 20 per

average speed of about 2600 kbps. This recording time could have been better. The Nero average read speed of 37.4X is however comparable to the best.

One CD-RW and one CD-R media are provided *gratis* with the drive, along with Nero Burning ROM. Bundled with this is an operating guide for Nero, a users guide and an audio cable for listening to Audio CDs.

Given the satisfactory performance, standard bundled accessories and reasonable price tag. The BenQ is definitely worth a look, if a slight compromise on performance is acceptable to you.

SPECIFICATIONS

134 x 39 x 165 mm, 1 Kg, read speed 48X, write speed 48X, ReWrite 16X, E-IDE/ATAPI interface, Seamless Link (buffer under-run proof), 2 MB buffer size, compatible with Windows 95/98/ME/NT 4.0/2000/XP.

Box Contents: Nero Burning ROM, Audio cable, 1 CD-R and 1 CD-RW medium, user manual, Nero operating guide

Price: Rs 3,450
Contact: BenQ India Pvt Ltd
Phone: 022 - 25705231
Fax: 022 - 25705235
Web site: kamleshsalunke@benq.com
Web site: www.benq.co.in

BenQ CRW4816A		B+
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶	
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶	
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶	
Features	▶▶▶▶▶	
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶	

ECS K7VTA3 mainboard

An affordable solution

The K7VTA3 is built around the VIA KT333 chipset that combine support for the faster DDR 333 SDRAM and the AC'97 audio codec. The motherboard supports the AMD 462-pin Socket A interface, with a 100 or 133 MHz DDR front-side bus, accommodating the Athlon and Duron range of processors.

The motherboard has five PCI expansion slots, RAID support and two USB 2.0 ports, apart from two serial ports, a parallel port and a MIDI/game port. It also has a 4x AGP slot for attaching a graphics card. There is a Communications Network Riser (CNR) slot, which can

remotely shift the computer from 'standby' to 'power up', over a network. The components on the motherboard are well placed, with small tabs near the CPU socket that protect the board from screwdriver slips during heat sink installation. There is enough space between the memory clips and the AGP slot to avoid inconvenience during installation. On the flipside, the ATX power connector could have been placed more towards the edge of the board.

Our testbed was powered by an AMD Athlon XP 2400+ processor, a Kingston 256 MB DDR333 SDRAM stick, an IBM Deskstar 40 GB hard drive, a MSI GeForce4 Ti4600 graphics card, and a 17-inch monitor. We ran a number of real world and synthetic tests to get a clear picture of its performance. The Ti4600 add-on card gives the system enough

power to handle high-end gaming, yielding a more than adequate score of 222.3 frames per second, while playing *Quake III Arena* at the highest quality settings and 1024 x 768 resolution, 32-bit colour. The 3DMark 2001 tested the Direct3D capability of the system, which scored 9643 in the benchmark run at 1024 x 768 resolution, 32-bit colour. However, the CPU Index score of 4365 was lower than other boards.

The installation CD, also contains some useful software such as Acrobat Reader, PC-Cilin, CD Ghost, Genesys, Language Genius and MediaRing Talk.

The ECS motherboard along with an AMD Athlon 2400+ provides a good solution for Internet browsing and content creation. Hardcore gamers can install a graphics card to match their needs. Overall, this is a simple motherboard, a good choice if looking for reasonable quality at a good price.

SPECIFICATIONS

305 mm x 244 mm, ATX motherboard, Socket 462, VIA KT333 chipset, 3x DDR 200/266/333 slots accommodating a maximum of 3 GB memory, 5 PCI slots, 2x IDE connectors, IDE RAID support, Communications Network Riser slot, 2x USB 2.0 ports, 2x PS/2 ports, 2x serial ports, one parallel port, one MIDI/game port, jacks for microphone, Line-In and Line-Out.

Box Contents: User's guide, installation CD, ATA 100 cable floppy drive cable

Price: Rs 5,500
Contact: Great World tech Pvt Ltd
Phone: 022-23892828
Fax: 022-23879020
E-mail: sales@gtechworld.com
Website: www.ecs.com.tw

ECS K7VTA3 mainboard		B+
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶	
Build Quality	▶▶▶▶▶	
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶	
Features	▶▶▶▶▶	
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶	